# END USER COMPUTING.

# BICT 1101

# Lecture 6: Net Netiquette

# Netiquette

- "Netiquette" stands for "Internet Etiquette“
  - refers to the set of practices developed over the years to make *Internet* experience pleasant for everyone.
  - Netiquette is a set of rules for behaving properly online.
  - Netiquette is concerned with matters of courtesy in communications.
- Etiquette - the set of rules or customs which control accepted behaviour in particular social groups or social situations.

# E-mail Etiquette

- E-mail is frequently written quickly and often poorly.
- The following tips should help you to write e-mails that will be well received every time.
- Pay attention to punctuation, spelling, grammar and capitals.

- Many e-mail messages contain poor spelling and grammar, incorrect use of capital letters and/or poor punctuation.
- Such messages look unprofessional (substandard) and certainly produce a poor impression of the sender.

**Your subject line should be descriptive.**

- Many people get a lot of of e-mail messages per day, and some of it being spam (i.e. unsolicited sales messages),
  - Your message may be deleted unread if the subject line makes it look unimportant or spamish.

## Use short paragraphs and leave lines between them.

- You can make things easier for your readers by using short, clearly separated paragraphs.
- You might also indent the text on the first line of each paragraph.

## Don't send unsolicited attachments

- A movie file may be the funniest thing you've seen for a long time, but don't automatically send it to everyone to know.
- Ask them first if they want to receive it.
- Some people have slow internet connection, your 3 megabyte file is going to lock up their Internet connection for quarter of an hour or so.
- Be polite and ask first.

**Ensure that your PC is protected against viruses.**

- Unless you take suitable precautions (like regularly downloading the latest antivirus definitions for your antivirus software),
- you run the risk of your machine becoming virus infected.

**Don't type in ALL CAPITALS**

- It's considered SCREAMING.
- Who wants to read/hear from someone who's screaming all the time?
- It's ok to use a word in all capital letter to EMPHISIZE something;

- you just want to stay clear of writing everything that way. There other reason is:
  - Text in all capitals is harder to read.

**Stay away from spam.**

- **Spam** refers to unwanted messages posted to newsgroups or sent to a list of users through e-mail.
- Most forms of spam are:
  - Unwanted commercial advertising.
  - Chain letters.
- Think of spam as junk mail you get in your mail box.

- 99% of spam messages are going to be scams either trying to get your personal information or your money.
- Safest way is to delete it.
- Unless you know who the message is from don’t ever follow any links you may find.

**Wait a while before sending your message.**

- Proofreading your own work is a risky business, even a writer and proofreader by profession, makes mistakes
- The best strategy is to put writing aside for a while then look at it afresh.
- It's amazing what will often just leap out at you.

## Posting Your Pictures

- Internet chats or some email providers gives you the option of posting a picture next to your name.
- This is like of an identifying icon for you.
- Find a picture of appropriate size, small and doesn't take up the entire screen usually a passport size.
- Remember that a picture is going to represent your name and yourself in particular, if you want everyone in the chat to know what you look like.

**Never give any personal information.**

- Things like your address, phone number, Social Security Number, or credit card can be used to steal your identity and/or your money.
- This also means don't give your password to anyone.
- Passwords are intended to protect you, if you tell someone what it is, you've lost that protection.

**Do not send personal insults (Flames).**

- Think, before you send.
- Would you say that to someone's face?
- Would you want someone to talk that way to you?
- Would this be something you want your parents or children to repeat/hear?
- If you answered no to any of those, then don't send it.
- Don't fall into being a cyber bully.

**Shop only with secure web sites (https://).**

- It will not only protect you against identity theft but it's for your personal financial safety.

**Ignore pop-up windows.**

- ***Pop-ups*** are forms of online advertising on the World Wide Web intended to attract web traffic or capture email addresses.
  - If one pops up, just close it.
  - Never follow the links, pop ups can have viruses that can lock up your computer or steal your information.
  - Be smart, and just close them

**Send mature messages at work.**

- Don't assume any Internet communication is completely secure.
  - "Never put in a mail message anything you would not put on a postcard".
- If you are forwarding or re-posting a message, don't change the original wording.
- If you are replying to a message, quote only the relevant parts.
- Email should have a subject header that reflects the content of the message.

**Know where you are in cyberspace.**

- Always take a look around when you enter a new domain when surfing the web.
- Get a sense of what the discussion group is about before you join it.

**Respect other people's privacy**

- Do not read other people's emails without their permission.
- Going through other people's things could cost you your job or you could even go to jail.

**Be forgiving of other people's mistakes.**

- Do not point out mistakes to people online.
- You still need to have good manners even though you are online and can not see the person face to face.

## Adhere to the same standards online that you follow in real life.

- You need to behave the same way online that you do in real life.
- You need to remember that you can get caught doing things you should not be doing online just like you can in real life.
- You are still talking to a real person with feelings even though you can't see them.

# Share expert knowledge

- Ask questions online
- Share what you know online.
- Post the answers to your questions online because someone may have the same question you do.

# Remember the Human

- You need to remember that you are talking to a real person when you are online.
- Internet brings people together who would otherwise never meet.
- Remember this saying when sending an email:  Would I say this to the person's face ?

- Be very careful of copyrighted material.
- You can get sued for using it without permission.
- If you need to download a large file, do it during non-business hours.
- Internet is like a highway, it has traffic jams.
- Don’t slow everyone else down just because you are using all the bandwidth listening to the radio online.

- Prepare to explore new places…
- Think of your mistakes as chances to learn something new
- Use your imagination
- Ask for help (and be sure to say thanks!)
- Show people the same respect you would if they were sitting right next to you

# Email Etiquette

- Check your email daily
- Delete unwanted messages.
- Keep messages in your inbox to a minimum.
- Mail messages can be downloaded and saved for future references.
- Use common sense.
- Proof read messages before sending.
- Typing in all CAPITAL letters in an email is equivalent to shouting.
- Use spell check and check grammar before sending.
- Use proper punctuation.